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3

LETTERS T₀ MJB

Mr Dave Cooper writes from Bilton:

' Please send me your 3 latest tapes : 1 Centre Counter with 2 .. Qd5: 2 Thor Speaks 3 French Advance. I have been eagerly awaiting some new tapes from you for some time. I would like to keep your "Basman at the British" tape as I think its your best to date !'

' What about a tape on the Morra ? My new grade is 120 ! '

And from Walthamstow's Chatham Road, Mr Mick O'Neill asks :

' After 1 e4 d5 2 ed: Qd5: 3 Nc3 Qa5 4 d4 Nf6 what if white plays 5 Bd3 thereby preventing black's .. Bf5. I presume black should play .. Bg4 with a view to exchanging bishop for knight or is there something better ? If instead of interposing his knight here white plays f3 intending to post his knight, eventually, on e4, is Bf5 unsound for black or should be retreat it to d7 ?'

MJB replies : " 5 Bd3 does not actually prevent .. Bf5 though white has a possible pawn sac : 6 b4 Qb4: 7 Bf5: Qc3:+ 8 Bd2 Qd4: 9 Nf3 Qd8. The other move, 5 .. Bg4 looks OK. After either .. Bf5 or .. Bd7 and white has no compensation for his draughty Kingside; if 6 Nf3 Nbd7 7 h3 Bh5 8 g4 Bg6 looks alright; white does not have the outpost move 9 Ne5 here."

Next issue : 'The English Def with 4 e3' by E García, Gerard Welling at Biel, ' Wild Grob ' by M Orr and OH Hardy writes us.

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Audio Chess News, 7 Billockby Close, Chessington, Surrey.

AUDIO CHESS NEWS No. 3

Editor-in-Chief : I.M. MJ Basman

Production Editor : James Pratt

Welcome to
Issue 3 of
Audio Chess
News. A word
about notation

- please submit games in short
form algebraic; if you cannot
type your script make sure
it is well laid out.

We use ' : ' meaning captures,
' + ' means check, ' ♠ ' only
move, ' Δ ' with the idea of ...,
(-->) see diagram. Algebraic
notation is fully explained in
Issue No 1 of " Rabbits' Review ".
If you are unclear on any point, let
us know.

ACN - The magazine for chess nutz and screwballz !:

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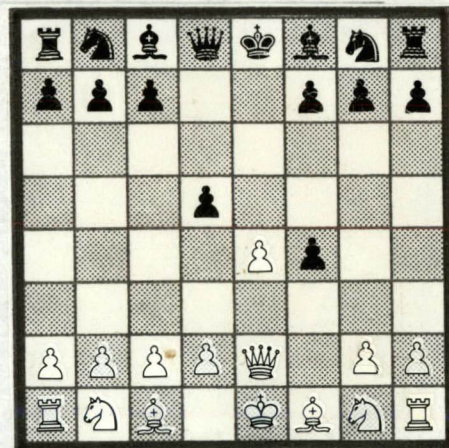
M. Basman

James Pratt

Bazz concludes ...

WIERDO K ORNER

In ACN No 2 (P15-18) we examined the KGA line : 1 e4 e5 2 f4 ef: and now the party stopping sortie 3 Qe2! Now we look at 3 .. d5 (--->) Though white can capture the pawn and call check it's not so good as black will answer with 4 .. Be7 and proceed to castle and put a rook on e8. Therefore, I think white should play 4 Nc3 . We now have two main moves : (i) 4 .. d4 and (ii) 4 .. de:



There are two stem games, both of which I lost.

(i) 4 .. d4. White could now play 5 Nd1 possibly moving it round to f2 later; but, more enterprising is : 5 Nd5!? g5. He is threatening to trap the white knight with 6 .. c6. White's reply is thematic : 6 Qh5 and another point of delaying Nf3 is revealed. White's queen can traverse the d1-h5 diagonal, doing valuable work. Here she parries the threat of 6 .. c6, which would be answered by 7 Nf4: gf: 8 Qe5+, which picks up the rook. Black could now consider 6 .. h6, since 7 Nf4: would be met by 7 .. Nf6! So white should play 7 Bc4! Be6! and now 8 Nc7:? Qc7: 9 Be6: is no good because of 9 .. Nf6. It would not be any good to play 8 Nf3 because this cuts off the retreat of the queen. I decided the way to counter was to play 8 c3 c6 and 9 Qe2 and she's back in business again.

squared bishop and can castle into safety with good winning chances due to his bishop pair and better pawn structure.

If white then plays 18 Bf3 , to attack e7 and try to stop black castling, then 18 .. Ba4! eg 19 Qe2 Be1: 20 Re1: 00! 21 Qe7:?? Re8. If 20 Qe1: Rd7 21 Bg4 Rc7 22 Qa5 b6, followed by .. 00. Or 18 Bg4 Bg4: 19 Qg4: Ba1: 20 Ra1: 00, with good endgame prospects.)

(" Is white so badly off in the Q v R+N endgame ? Try 18 Qc1 Be1: 19 Qe1: 00 20 h4 with ideas of h5 and Qd2-g5." - MJB)

17 Bg7: Rg8 (Now the black King has to stay in the centre)
18 Bf3? (18 Bd4 keeps a clear positional plus without unnecessary pyrotechnics)

18 .. Rg7: 19 dc: Be6? (Better 19 .. Rc8! 20 cd:+ Qd7: when although black's position is not enviable, he is two pawns ahead with chances)

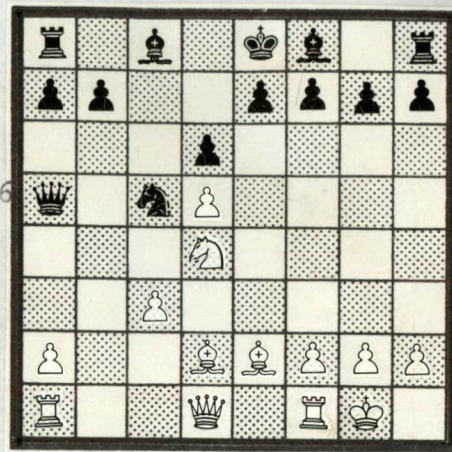
20 c7! Qc7: (If 20 .. Qc8 21 Rb1 d5 22 Qd4 wins)

21 Ba8: Bc4:?? (Suicidal. Black's position was awkward, but not totally lost. White should have won, perhaps, but after, say 21 .. f6 22 Bd5 Kf7 ▲ Rg8 etc black could still have put up stiff resistance) (" Maybe not 22 .. Kf7 because of 23 Re6: etc " - MJB)

22 Qd4 Ne6 23 Re6! Be6:(?) 24 Qg7: Ba2: (What if 25 Ra2:?) 25 Qb2 Be6 26 Rc1 Qd8 27 Bc6+ 1-0.

(If 27 .. Bd7 or .. Kf8 28 Qh8 is mate.)

(-->) 12 .. Bd7 (Here it would appear that black can play 12 .. g6!? eg 13 c4 Qd8 14 Bc3 Ne4! 15 Bb2 (15 Nc6 Nc3!) 15 .. Nf6 followed by Bg7 and 00 completing his kingside development. 12 .. Ne4 allows the unpleasant 13 Bb5 +, when black's King has to stay in the centre)



13 c4?!. (While it is pleasant to make such a forcing move, it is probably not the best. Why not wait to see if a better opportunity presents itself? Note also that after this move white does not retain the option of embarrassing black with Bb5. 13 Re1 looks more to the point; Δ 13 .. Ne4 14 Rb1!) 13 .. Qd8 14 Re1 g6 15 Bc3 (Δ 16 Nc6. As we shall see, black can ignore this, so perhaps white should have considered others ?) 15 .. Bg7! 16 Nc6 ?!

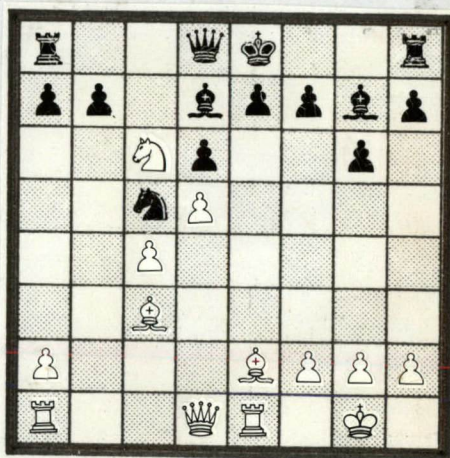
(-->) This looks crushing on the face of things but really, as we shall see, it is sheer bluff in an inferior position. Other moves, of course, allow black to castle a pawn up.)

16 .. bc:?? (Yes, a blunder.

After 16 .. Bc3: 17 Nd8: Rd8:

With black's bishop forking white's

rooks, so black will have R, N & P for his Q, he will also have a dominating knight against white's ineffective white

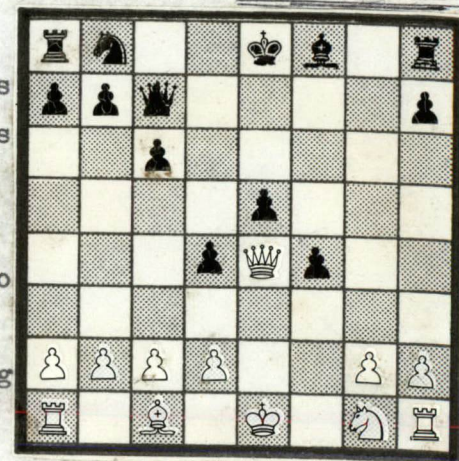
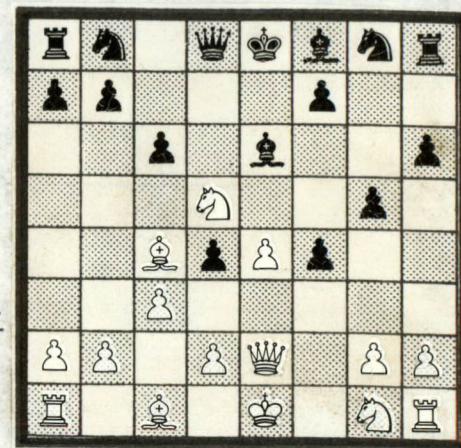


The white queen maintains the knight at d5 for another move; can you see how ? I suppose black's best here would be 9 .. Bc8 which drives the knight away from its post. Play might continue : 10 Nb4 a5 11 Nd3 (11 Nc2 b5 12 Bd3 maybe better) 11 .. b5 12 Bb3 a4 13 Bc2 and the pawn advance

may have damaged black more than white. In the game Basman v J Century, Club Match '73, black did not play 6 .. h6 but 6 .. Be6 7 Bc4 c6 White does not have time to play 8 Qe2 because after 8 .. Bc8 the white knight is lost. So instead of moving his queen, white plays : 8 Nc7+ Qc7: 9 Be6: Nf6 10 Qg5: A disadvantage of not playing .. h6 is revealed. 10 .. Ne4: 11 Qf5 fe: 12 Qe4: e5. (-->)

The smoke has cleared and white has total white square control. Black's pawns still occupy the central black points, but the white queen nestles in between. Yet the position is finely balanced. Black has an extra pawn and threatens to dislodge the white queen with .. Nd7 and .. Nc5 . White can try Nf3 and d3 threatening to capture on f4 with the bishop.

So now : 13 Nf3 Nd7 . A critical position. White could regain his pawn now with 14 Nd4: but this loses time after 14 .. Nc5!



15 Qe2 000 16 Nf3 e4 and the blockade is broken.
 Go back a move and play instead of 13 Nf3 (so automatic it must be weak) 13 d3 which threatens the immediate 14 Bf4: so 13 .. Nd7 , which prepares black to castle long, is not available to black here (13 .. Nd7 14 Bf4: 000 15 Bg5 Re8 16 Nf3 Nc5 17 Qf5+ etc) . Moreover, 13 .. Bb4+ is pointless after 14 c3 (14 .. dc:?? 15 Qb4:) and 13 .. Be7 drops a tempo as opposed to our game continuation, and after 14 Nf3 Nd7 15 00, black finds castling is not easy here either ie 15 .. 000 16 Bf4: ef: 17 Qe7: .

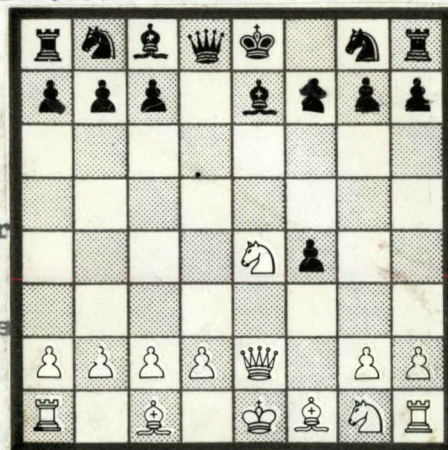
Well, it is good to have 20-20 hindsight, but in the game I now ground to a halt after 14 00 000 15 d3 Bd6 16 Bd2 Kb8 17 b4 Nf6 18 Qe2 Rhg8 and 0-1 on adjudication 20 moves later when I was still my gambit pawn down.

To move on to one of the most critical lines :

1 e4 e5 2 f4 ef: 3 Qe2 d5 4 Nc3 and now : (ii) 4 .. de: . This opens the position and black hopes he will eventually benefit on the open e file

5 Ne4: Be7(→→)

White wants to get in d4, to take on f4 and castle long or castle more safely on the kingside, by means of the manoeuvre Qf2, Be2 (or d3) and then 00. Black will hasten to put a rook on e8 before white has got out of the way. Since he cannot play .. Nf6 on the next move (because of white's Nf6:+ trebling the



gives white considerable pressure, according to Shamkovich) MJB played 11 Bd2 Qe5: 12 00 Qd5: 13 Rb1! and 1-0 in 26.)

10 00 (A very difficult position to assess. Having started in gambit style, white probably does best to continue in the same vein. Slower moves like 10 Qb3 - inviting Nd7-c5; 10 Bb2 - blocks the 'b' file and 10 Bd2 - leaves d5 en prise; are probably less good. Black's best plan must be to castle as quickly as possible, though this is by no means as simple as it may first seem.)

10 .. Nd7 (If 10 .. g6 then 11 Qd4 is embarrassing, while 10 .. Qc3: looks too greedy after 11 Rb1!)

11 Bd2? (I have to query this move since it is by no means clear that d2 is the best square for the bishop. 11 Re1 has to be the best move here with indirect pressure along the 'e' file. White then has possibilities such as Bf4 and Bd6: if the black King has to remain in the centre, while the black plan of .. g6 and .. Bg7 no longer looks viable)

11 .. Nc5 ? (Again it is not clear that this is going to be the best square for the beastie; f6 may well be better, but why not take the pawn at d5 so as to be able to develop by .. e6, .. Be7, and 00 ?)

12 Nd4 (Centralisation like this can hardly be wrong in principle, but other moves come into serious consideration, eg: 12 c4 (Δ 12 .. Qd8 13 Bc3) Qa3 13 Nd4 (Δ Nb5 or f4 and Rf3) or 12 Re1 Ne4 13 Rb1! or even 12 Rb1 and if 12 .. Qa2: 13 Bb5+)

S TUART**K** NOX'S**C**OLUMN

From the Grieson, Grant British U-21's at Morecambe, 1981

W : GN Strouts (162 j)

B : AJ Toll (148) (3 Be2 Sicilian)

1 e4 c5 2 Nf3 d6 3 Be2 (' The White Opening ' by M Basman; 90 mins cassette for only £ 3.75) 3 .. Nc6 4 c3 Nf6 5 d4 cd: (5 .. Ne4:? 6 d5 Nb8 and 7 Qa4+ is an old joke, (as in J Pratt v GR Wood, BCF U-16's, 1975) which doubtless claims dozens of victims a week)

6 cd: Ne4:!! (Shamkovich recommends 6 .. d5 here without any supporting analysis. After 7 e5 Ne4 black may find it difficult or impossible to retreat his knight if white tries to win it with f3, so perhaps 7 .. Nd7 ▲ Nb6, .. Bg4, .. e6 etc is best.)

7 d5 Qa5+ ♚ 8 Nc3(!) Nc3: (8 .. Ne5 9 Ne5: de: 10 00 was played in Palatnik v Ljubojevich, Belgrade '74, when, in ECO, Palatnik now gives 10 .. Nc3: 11 bc: e6 12 Bf3 ed: 13 Bd5: Bc5 14 Re1 00 15 Re5: Be6! with equality. After 8 .. Nc3:, as in the text, I think the open 'e' and 'b' files give white good compensation for his pawn. Therefore, I would like to recommend for black 8 .. Nb8 9 00 Nf6, keeping the 'b' file closed, stopping Bb5+, keeping black's King in the centre and retaining another piece to defend with) 9 bc: Nb8! (Obviously not 8 .. Qc3:?? as 9 Bd2 wins a piece. M Basman v MF Stean, Hastings '73/74 went 9 .. Ne5?! 10 Ne5: Qc3:? (Although 10 .. de: 11 Qb3 a6 12 Ba3!

black f pawns). Black is very likely to play the move .. Be6 and .. Nf6 and finally .. 00. White can harrass the bishop on e6 by Ng5 . So play can be complex, but I have given you an outline of what both sides are aiming at.

6 Nf3 Nc6 7 c3 This looks slow, but white must keep the black knight out of the d4 square and also preparing to play d4. 7 .. Be6 8 d4 Nf6(→→)

Black is now ready to castle and has a lead in development, and white's queen is awkward at e2.

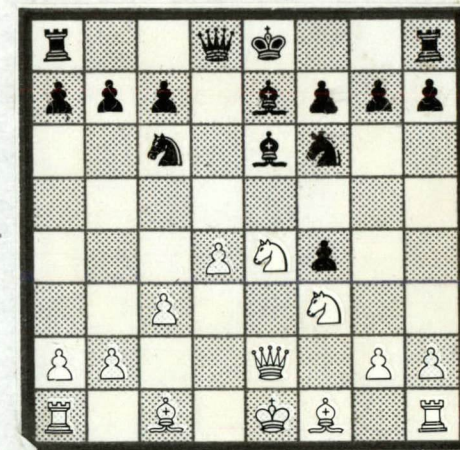
At the same time, white can overcome his present difficulties of development and king safety, he will have good game. His pawn at d4 is firmly supported and the black knight at c6 is limited in its actions by the two pawns at c3 and d4.

Now, 9 Neg5 could be answered by 9 Bd5 and after 10 Bf4: h6 the white knight can retreat.

9 Nf6:+ seems to help black a bit by clearing the e file. After 9 .. Bf6: 10 Bf4: 00 11 Qd2 Re8 12 Kf2 Ne7 (Redeveloping a futile beast) black has plenty of harrassment up his sleeve.

9 Bf4: 00 10 Neg5 Bd5 is more interesting, since after 11 Qf2 h6 white can offer a piece by 12 h4 hg: 13 hg: Nh7 14 Bd3 Ng5: 15 Ng5: Bg5: 16 Bh7+ seems to $\frac{1}{2}$ draw at least.

9 Nfg5!? is interesting since white is prepared to answer



9 .. Bd5 with 10 Nf6:+ gf: shattering black's king-side. Black could ignore everything with bravado viz : 9 .. 00 but after 10 Ne6: fe: 11 Ng5 despite his lead in development, black is not looking so good after white takes the e pawn.

On the other hand, black could go for 9 .. Ne4: 10 Ne6: Bh4+ (10 .. fe: 11 Qe4: Bh4+ 12 Kh1 seems good for white as he will have good sway over the white squares with his queen and bishop) 11 Kd1 Nf2+ 12 Qf2: looks equal although white can try for more with 12 Kc2 .

A third line for black is to play 9 .. Qd7 10 Bf4: 000 11 Ne6: Qe6: 12 Ng5 Qd5 13 Qf3 , in which case white has the bishop pair.

So what happened in the game ? The game was MJ Basman v WR Hartston, Cutty Sark British Championship Play-off, '74 and it was the sixth (and last) game. I had already lost the match. Disasterously. So here was a chance to turn disaster into humiliation by playing the 3 Qe2 line in the KGA. I was not to be disappointed.

1 e4 e5 2 f4 ef: 3 Qe2 d5 4 Nc3 de: 5 Ne4: Be7 6 Nf3 Nc6 7 c3 Bf5! 8 d4 Qd5!

I had not noticed black's seventh move, and just carried on routinely. Now after black's 8 .. Qd5! all I could do was gnash my teeth impotently (again) at another muffed opening. White cannot hold e4 and must move his knight, and meanwhile black whisks his king to the queen's wing and threatens .. Re8. The further course of the game is unnecessary as it was only a friendly (0-1 in 34). I should have asked for

his Queen with my King to protect the 'e' pawn in preparation for an ending that might favour black.)

15 Qa7: (Temporarily putting white's best piece out of play) 15 .. Ne7! (Not a crude 16 .. Nc6 threat but planning .. Qc6 and now if d5 then Nd5:)

16 Ba3! (Winning a piece ?) 16 .. Qc6 ! (What a joy. He must stop the mate, but if 17 d5 Nd5: 18 cd: Qc3 hits every) 17 Be4 ef: 18 Be7: e3 19 d5 (I decided to play a risk free line guaranteeing me a better ending) 19 .. ef:+ 20 Kf2:

(-->) 20 .. Qc4: 21 Qa3 Rd5:

22 Rd5: Qd5: 23 Ke3 Qe4+

24 Kd2 Qg2+ 25 Kd3 Qh2:

26 Bh4 (Possibly 26 .. h6 4 g5 wins material, but I was in time trouble so played obvious moves.) 26 .. Qg2 27 Qe7 Qf3+

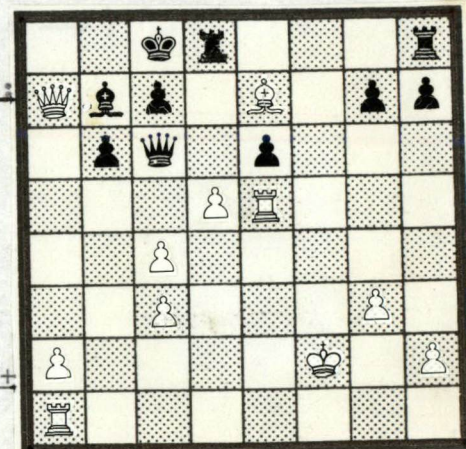
28 Kd2 Qd5+ 29 Kc2 Qf5+

30 Kb2 Qb5+ (Time control

reached) 31 Kc1 Qd7 32 Qb4 Qf7 33 Kb2 h6 34 Qd4 Rf8 35 g4 Qd7 36 Qb4 Qd2+ 37 Ka3 Rf3 38 Be1 Qd6 39 Kb2 Qb4:+ 40 cb: Rf4 41 a4 Rg4: 42 a5 ba: 43 ba: Ba6 0-1.

(" Nice win, Mr Green. Though 'strategically' good, the manoeuvre 6 .. Qh4 and back to e7 lost too much time. 5 .. f5 is simpler because if 6 ef: Bg2: 7 Qh5+ then just 7 .. Kf8. There was no hurry for 5 .. Bc3:+ either."

- MJB)



AN ENGLISH DEFENCE

by J Green of Epsom

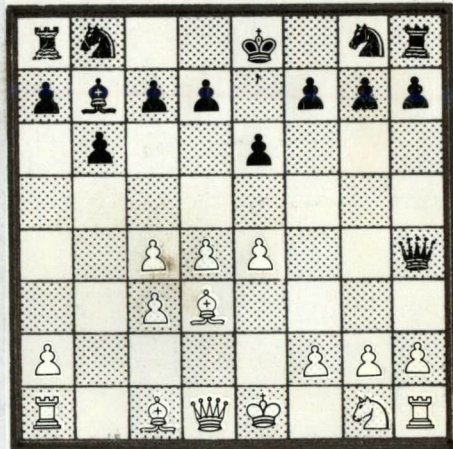
W : R Hessey (138 J)

B : J Green (134)

2nd Leg Wernick Cup Play-off (Notes by the winner for ACN)

1 d4 e6 2 c4 b6 3 Nc3 Bb7 4 e4 Bb4 5 Bd3 Bc3:+
6 bc: Qh4 (I chose this apparently rash move for psycholog-
ical reasons - I had beaten my opponent in the first round and
he thought the better man had lost ! I thought I'd confirm his
impression of me as a lightweight and planned a follow-up with
.. f5) (♞→)

7 g3 ? (Weakening the h1-a8
diagonal. I was particularly
pleased he'd played Bd3) 7 .. Qe7
8 Nf3 f5 9 e5 (Now I'd total
control of the diagonal but I had
problems to sort out ie getting my
knights into play and the planned
invasion of g5. I wanted to get
.. h6 and .. g5 in myself but was



nervous of weakening g6) 9 .. d6 10 00 Nd7 11 Re1 (Bg5 stops me castling and my Queen is obviously in danger) 11 .. de: 12 Ne5: (Which at least releases pressure on g5) 12 .. 000 (I realised there was still a possibility of 13 Bf5: ef: 14 Ng6 Qf6 and 15 Nh8: but thought I had a possible attack) 13 Qa4 Ne5: 14 Re5: Qd6 (Breaking the pin and preparing .. Qc6 . I do not think 14 .. Qd6 was a good move and 15 Bf4 might have lost me a pawn. Putting the Queen on d7 might have been better and then if white exchanges I take

my last two moves back. Having already won the Championship, I doubt Bill would have objected. For full reports see BCM March, '74 and Chess, Vol 39 P176-7.

After 8 d3 Qd5 9 Bf4: 000 white is still losing of course.

MORE SWINDLES by D Cooper

Rush back to ACN No 1, P9-12 to enjoy some interesting play and now here is more !

This game has got to be my favourite swindle (writes Mr Cooper)
The opening was ' a little strange ':

W : JE Mitchell

B : DM Cooper (Oxford v Cambridge, Freshmens' Match)

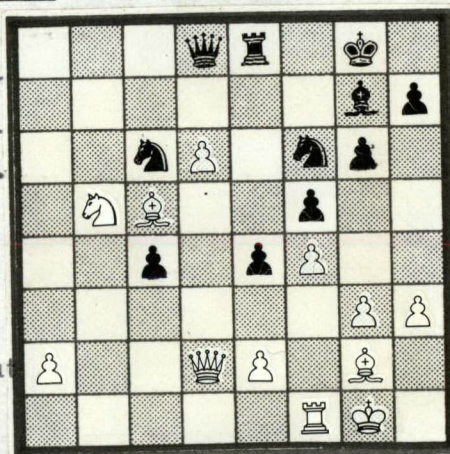
1 Nf3 g6 2 c4 Bg7 3 Nc3 d6 4 g3 e5 (.. Nf6 & .. c5
are safer but boring) 5 d4 Nc6 6 d5 (I was afraid of 6
de:) Nce7 7 Bg2 (Why not e4 ?) f5 8 00 Nf6 9 Ne1 00
(Both sides stand well. I was surprised by white's next) 10
f4 (Played after prolonged thought; this seems rather anti-
positional, since I could temporarily exclude his white-squared
bishop from the game.) 10 .. e4 (More intense consideration
was to produce :) 11 Be3 (" Ah, you want to play 12 c5 " I
thought and so played it myself) 11 .. c5 12 (I judged that
after 12 dc: bc: I would be able to play for d5) 12 h3
(I had to decide on a plan. Perhaps I was influenced by the
prolonged cogitations of my opponent to play quickly - he was
40 minutes ahead on the clock. This could have caused me to
think that I stood a lot better. So I hit upon the first plan
that came into my head. Play for .. b5.) (MJB writes : "12 ..Nh5

13 Kh2 Bc3: 14 bc: and now Qa5).

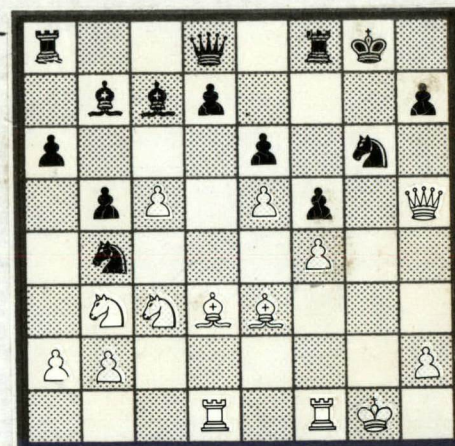
But after 12 .. a6 13 Rb1 Rb8 14 Qd2 I wasted a valuable move with 14 .. Bd7, when .. b5 could have been played immediately; this bishop move, despite giving protection to the unguarded QR and striking at b5, blocks the queen's view of the d file.

White played 15 Nc2, connecting his rooks; there came : 15 .. b5 - too late - 20 minutes thought then produced : 16 b4 which I'd ruled out. Now I was losing my way ; I rejected 16 .. cb: 17 Nb4: because it would open the g1-a7 and imperil my 'a' pawn, so I went in for what I thought was the lesser evil by playing : 16 .. bc: 17 bc: dc: 18 Bc5: Re8 19 Na3 " So you want to win my 'c' pawn ? I'll give up that white-squared bishop and when you've finished I'll take your 'd' pawn, and surely I won't stand worse ", I thought and played : 19 .. Bb5. Now imagine how I felt when he played 20 d6 . I resignedly played 20 .. Nc6 and watched the winning of a pawn with 21 Nab5: ab: 22 Rb5: Rb5: 23 Nb5: (»→)

I thought I was going to lose very quickly. White has a well protected passed pawn and the bishop pair whereas my 'c' pawn is rather weak . However, calmer thought took over; I was 20 minutes ahead on the clock , his B on g2 was shut out, and the d6 pawn can be blockaded. I decided that passive



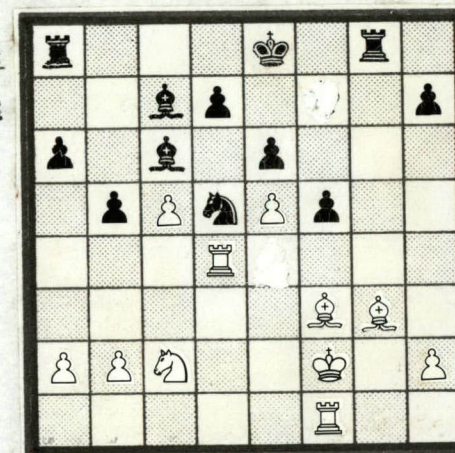
11 f4 f5 12 e5 b5 13 00 Bb7 14 Be3 g5 15 g3 gf: 16 gf: Ng6 (Δ Qh4) 17 Qh5 Nb4 (Black's QB is unusually active for this system) 18 Rad1 (»→) 18 .. Qh4 19 Qh4: Nh4: 20 Nd4 Kf7 21 Bf2 Ng2 (So if Bg3 Ne3) 22 Nc2 Nf4: (Δ .. Nh3 mate) 23 Be4! Nbd5 24 Nd5: Nd5: 25 Bg3 Ke8 26 Bf3 (White seems to be getting counter-play. I was considering putting my King on a7 !) 26 .. Bc6 27 Rd4 Rg8 28 Kf2 (»→)



28 .. f4 29 Bh5+ Kd8 30 Bf4: (If Bh4+ Kc8 - Be5:) 30 .. Nf4: 31 Rf4: Be5: 1-0.

White loses at least another pawn.

' A great game ' - MJB



* ACN 3 * ACN 3 * ACN 3 * ACN 3 * ACN 3 * ACN 3 * ACN 3 * ACN 3 *

Here are the answers to GMM II (ACN No2 P2) :

Lajos Portisch, Bruno Parma, Salo Flohr, Peter Clarke, Hugh Alexander, Murray Chandler, David Goodman, Brian Eley, Jacques Mieses, Grob or Spike, ML Hebden, Yes, Dolmatov, Theoretical Novelty. We'll have another quiz before long.

W : AT Marshall (187)

B : KJ Thurlow. London League, 1981.

4 .. Bc5 Sicilian (Notes by the player of the black pieces)

1 e4 c5 2 Nf3 e6 3 d4 cd: 4 Nd4: Bc5 5 Nb3 Bb6

6 c4 Nc6 7 Nc3 a6 (To stop Nb5) 8 Bf4 Nge7 9 Bd6

Bc7 10 c5 00 11 f4 f5 12 e5 g5 13 g3 (If 13 fg:

Ne5: etc black has a monstrous centre) 13 .. gf: 14 gf:

Ng6 15 Qh5 (He feared 15 Bf8: Qh4+ 16 Ke2 Nf4:+ or

if 16 Kd2 Qf4:+, black takes the 'e' pawn later and stands

well) 15 .. Bd6: 16 cd: Qb6

17 Qf3 (→→) 17 .. Qa7 ('Why

not 17 .. Nd4 18 Nd4: Qd4:

19 ah! - 18 Qf2 Qc6 19 Bg2

Nf4: 20 Qg3+ ; but black

could still play .. Nd4 on move

18 ' - MJB) 18 . h4 b5 19 h5

Nce5: 20 fe: Bb7 21 Qf2 Bh

22 hg: hg: 23 Qa7: Ra7: 24

Kf2 Kg7 (Black must have good

chances here, but I was suffering from 'flu and went badly

wrong) 25 Nc5 Bc6 26 b4 Rh8 27 a4 ba:? 28 Ba6:

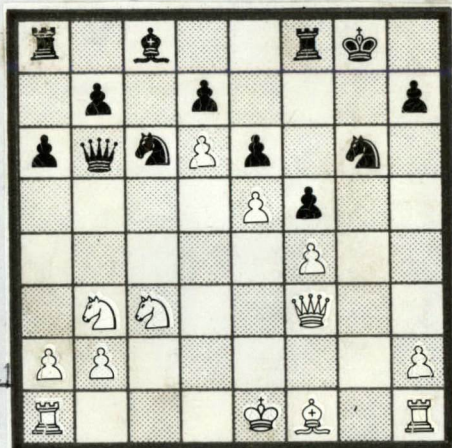
Rh2+ 29 Ke3 Rb2 30 b5 Bb5: 31 Bb5: Rb5: 32 Nb5:

Ra5 33 Ne6: de: 34 d7 Ra8 Nc7 1-0.

W : I Upton

B : KJ Thurlow. Surrey Open, 1981 (First 5 moves the same)

6 Bd3 Ne7 7 c4 Nbc6 8 c5 Bc7 9 Nc3 a6 10 Qe2 00



defence would allow such plans as Rb1, a4, e3, Bf1 etc and made the paradoxical decision to play : 23 .. Qa5.

Not wishing to go to b2 he obliged 24 Qa5: Na5: ♘ I now had hopes of holding out, especially after the over-protecting time-trouble move 25 Rd1, instead of the better Rb1 or Ra1. I hit the bishop with 25 .. Nd7, but instead of playing the bishop to d4 and aiming to swap it, he could not resist the opportunity of 'gaining a tempo' and played : 26 Bb4, deflecting my off-side knight into the game with : 26 .. Nc6. After 27 Bc3 can you spot a swindle coming ? (What, no ! Get Simon Webb's tape " Swindle Your Way to Success " 90 Mins for only £3.75 - JP)

After that commercial I played : 27 .. Rb8 thinking ' If he doesn't fall for it and retreats the knight, I can get on the seventh; if he plays a4, I'll ... cross that bridge later.' There followed : 28 Bg7: Kg7: and now the time-trouble move 29 Rb1, a square the rook could have gone to four moves ago. I instantly replied : 29 .. Nd4, and seeing that the knight was pinned, he played the horrible 30 Nc3? . I happily played 30 .. Ne2:+ and then grabbed his knight. He resigned. Noticeably his KB never scented my active play. Oxford won the match 8-4, despite the absence of Watson, Cummings and Erik Teichmann.

Next ish, some daylight robbery in the 4 .. Bc5 Sicilian !

~~~~~ A C N ~~~~~

Have you got the new "Audio Chess" Catalogue ? The full list of tapes, mags, Turnover books is more monstrous than before .

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" St George's Opening " : 4 X C90 Cassettes. 68 page booklet.  
Sturdily boxed. A/C 1980. Basman.

( .. e6 .. a6 .. b5 ! ) is not an opening, it is a defence and the booklet incorrectly states that Spassky played Petrosian for the World Title in 1963. It was three years later than this when Boris netted himself  $\frac{1}{2}/2$  by trying an early .. b5 ( Games 14 & 22 ); see 'Chess' Vol 31, the June and July '66 issues for a good analyses of these games. Also, ink in the missing pawn on Board 31 in the booklet (on a2).

These cassettes have been rerecorded and updated and now the excitement of Miles' win over Karpov at Skara has quietened we can return for a subjective look at St G's. The French, Polish, Owen's, Sicilian and English Defences have all themes in common with this system and transposition and comparison is where MJB begins his lecture, discussing the origin of this .. b5 complex. The 'Three Pawns Attack' 1 e4 e6 2 d4 a6 3 c4 b5!? which involves gambiting a flank pawn for pressure against white's centre using a timely .. f5, is discussed.

Tape 2 shows the difficulties you are likely to encounter if you play this line ( cf Game 1 v Van der Sterren ) and some of Basman's early failures. The important d5 square for black's knight is stressed and I was struck at the need to be a good tactician to win with St G's. There is an element of risk in playing it but maybe no more than with the Sicilian.

Tape 3 shows the similarity of St G's with the French and some games where Basman makes an early .. g5 thrust. Sicilian-like

positions, normally when white has played d4 x c5 are discussed next and some bludgeoned mating attacks on the Kingside are demonstrated.

Tape 4 discusses the move 1 .. a6, the idea of transposing into the French to combat 2 a4?! and finally the Karpov v Miles game is given.

One slight irrelevance : a game to note is Ljubojevich v  
Larsen, Montreal '79 : 1 e4 e6 2 d3 b5!?( A favourite  
of Kevin Wicker's ) 3 d4 ( Keene v Basman, Bognor '67 went:  
3 Nf3 Bb7 4 g3 Nf6 5 Bg2 Bc5?! 6 00 00 7 Nbd2  
d6 8 Qe2 Bb6 and white broke-through on the k-side; black  
sorely missed his bishop on e7; 1-0 in 34 ) 3 .. Bb7 4 Nd2  
Nf6 5 e5 Nd5 6 Ngf3 a6 ( Gufeld questions this calling  
6 .. b4 "more in the spirit of the Sokolsky" ) 7 Nb3 Nc6 8  
c3 Nb6 9 Bd3 Be7 10 Qe2 d6 11 00 de: 12 Ne5: ( 11  
in 42 )

Verdict : this is an important system, that can also be played by white with a move in hand, and could be just what you are looking for to spice-up your games. Playing it is quite a challenge. Of course, against 1 d4 you can play an immediate 1 .. b5 and there is even a sister cassette about that ( 90 minutes for only £ 3.75 ).

Musical interludes also feature which is jolly, to say the least.

JP JP JP JP JP JP JP JP JP JP JP JP JP JP JP JP JP JP JP JP JP JP JP JP

SORRY : In ACN No 1 P3; for Olypiad read Olympiad. Also give yourself a bonus mark if you spotted our mistake in Grandmaster Mind I ( P7 Question 7 ) Sultan Khan was born in Pakistan.